

LOTUS APPAREL (PVT) LTD

Social Compliance Policy: Child Labour and Forced Labour

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LA-HR-010	03	15/01/2026	Shiromi Gunasekara (HR Manager)	Rohan Weerakkody (Managing Director)

1. Policy statement

Lotus Apparel (Pvt) Ltd does not use or support child labour or any form of forced, bonded or involuntary labour. This policy applies to all workers employed directly by the company and to workers supplied by any labour agency or contractor working on our premises.

2. Child labour and young workers

2.1 Minimum age

The minimum age for employment in any role at the factory is **18 years**. This is higher than the legal minimum and applies equally to apprentices, trainees and agency workers.

2.2 Age verification

1. Every applicant presents an original National Identity Card (NIC) at recruitment. The HR officer checks the date of birth encoded in the NIC number against the date of birth on the card.
2. The birth certificate is requested as a second document and compared with the NIC.
3. Where documents are doubtful, the applicant is not employed until age is confirmed by the relevant Divisional Secretariat.
4. A photocopy of the verified NIC is kept on the personnel file; the original is always returned to the applicant on the same day.
5. HR conducts an internal audit of 10% of new personnel files each quarter to confirm that age verification was completed.

2.3 Remediation

If a person under 18 is ever found working on the premises, they are removed from work immediately, paid their full wages to date, and supported to return to education or vocational training, with a monthly stipend until they reach the minimum age, at which time they are offered employment.

3. Forced labour and freedom of movement

- **No retention of documents.** The company never keeps original identity cards, passports, certificates or any other personal documents.
- **No recruitment fees.** Workers pay no fee or deposit to the company or to any agent for recruitment. Any fee found to have been charged is reimbursed in full.
- **Freedom to resign.** Workers may leave employment by giving the notice stated in their contract, and final wages are paid within the statutory period. No penalty or deduction is applied for resignation.

- **Freedom of movement.** Workers may use toilets, drinking water and rest areas at any time without permission. Gates are not locked during working hours, and workers are free to leave the premises after their shift.
- **Voluntary overtime.** Overtime is voluntary. Each worker signs a monthly overtime consent form, and refusal of overtime does not lead to any penalty or loss of benefits.
- **No wage deductions as punishment.** Deductions are limited to those permitted by law.

4. Responsibilities and review

The HR Manager is responsible for implementing this policy and for training all supervisors on it annually. Labour agencies must sign an undertaking to comply with this policy before supplying any worker. The policy is reviewed every year by the Managing Director.

Rohan Weerakkody
Managing Director

Shiromi Gunasekara
HR Manager